



NEWSLETTER

Lent 2023

Dear Readers,

As always, thank you so much for all your creative entries!

This AFC term began with an engaging talk from Dr. Sam Lucy as our swap with the Women's History Society about female burials within the Cambridge region. Our second swap of term was not as successful, however, as Oxf*rd cancelled on us. Nevertheless, our members still enjoyed a weekend of events including an O*f*rdless museum crawl and *xfordless Selwyn brunch. A classic AFC film night watching Ice Age at Fitz led to a heated debate between Team Manny and Team Diego. We also hosted our first Open Meeting in 5 years allowing members a chance to give feedback and share ideas. Our first swap with the newly-revived Classics Society took place in G5 for an evening of mosaic making. We also had a HUGE stash drop on the end of term, can't wait to see everyone dripped out in our designs!

We rounded off term with the return of the renowned AFC Feast, making the long journey to far away lands (Homerton College) for an evening of good food, bad speeches and the handing over of the torch of AFC President. From the two of us: it's been a blast, and good luck next year!

Lots of love,

Mia + Hannah

If you have any questions/comments/threats/submissions, get in touch with the Editorial Committee (Hannah, hc581). Please note this is intended for circulation within the society only

Events!Events!Events!Events!

ELECTION RESULTS

Congratulations to the newly-elected incoming committee!

PRESIDENT	- EVAN GRANDIDGE DE PAZ
VICE PRESIDENT	- BEN STRATFORD
SECRETARY	- TRINITY BENSTOCK
TREASURER	- ALASDAIR HARRISON
EVENTS & SOCIAL OFFICERS	- LUKE BARBER & HANNAH BELSHAW
STASH AND PUBLICITY	- JENNA WELCH

As you may have seen if you're on the society's WhatsApp chat (message the publicity officer if you're not & want to be) we've started providing AFC **coffee, tea & oat milk** in the break room - help yourself & let us know if anything needs re-stocking.

Our stash came! Here's Mia as a t-shirt model:



FOOTBALL REPORT

The AFC football team joined forces with the ASNaCs to create "ASNaCology" (someone pls come up with a better name). We first lost 4-0 to the Robinson Choir (they had God on their side, fielding their Chaplain in attack). We didn't let this minor setback stop us squashing the Classicists a few weeks later and came home with a decisive 2-1 victory. They've promised us revenge next term so be ready!

COMING SOON:

- Winckelmann Cup 2024 - the biggest football competition between archaeologists in Europe
- Get excited for the garden party (!!!)

If you have any suggestions for events, please get in touch with Hannah (hb671) and Luke (lb2030) - your new events team



NEWS FROM ABROAD

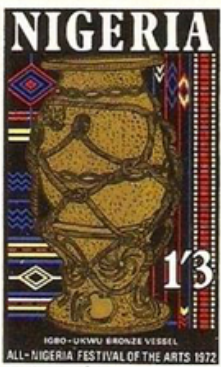
Salve from the Classics Society! Our first full term of events has been even better than expected. We started off the term with a relaxed movie night showing *Life of Brian* which brought the society together before our Zine craft night, where members of the society created beautiful and thought-provoking pieces using scraps from newspapers, poetry books, magazines etc to comment on Classics. Check out our instagram @camclassicsoc for examples of what we created! Halfway through the term we decided to join together with our favourite other ancient worlds society the AFC (sorry ASNaCs - just kidding!) to host a mosaic-making craft social, which was extremely popular and again produced some amazing work featured on our instagram. We hope to collaborate with the AFC more in future! We also took part in the battle for dominance playing football ⚽ against both the AFC and the ASNaCs - unfortunately this time we were defeated although we put up a great fight and look forward to round two. We ended the term with a symposium themed cocktail party, complete with reclining couches, togas and grapes to go round. All in all, we've had a great term and are looking forward to the next one - rumour has it a 'Caecilius est in horto' themed garden party might be on the cards!



To: Cambridge Archaeological Field Club

From: Elizabeth Eaton-Banks

(Cambridge Classics Society publicity officer)



TELEGRAM

No..... | Time Sent..... | To { Cambridge AFC
Time Received.....

CUBAS, much like the mammoth, appears to have gone extinct. Despite our hopeful projections in the previous AFC newsletter, Lent term has been somewhat societally unfruitful. Whether or not CUBAS will be resurrected later in 2024 (perhaps as a meatball or the whole thing?) remains an unsolved mystery... Meanwhile, feel free to buy some merch at:

<https://rivalkit.com/collections/cambridge-university-biological-anthropology-society>.

~ Thomas Prince (outgoing CUBAS secretary)

droveway

poem & photos by izzy bunting

slow-road and hollow-road:
you once likened it
to the carving of a bowl
how foot and flock shape land
like an iron blade to alder

and on hazy may mornings
when traffic-hum is muffled
by hills still cold with dawn
at the crossing-place you wonder
of the first to forge this path

and if you might be the last.
but tomorrow's shearing-day
and wool's muddied by the moss
you must hurry now to wash
your ghosts in river-water

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way.

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Uteri Votives

These sketches are of Uteri Votives, a type of object that sits within the trend of dedicating anatomical representations of the body to guide the god towards its healing, found at the Sanctuary at Gravisca, 8km from the Etruscan town of Tarquinia.

Their stylings draw both from frameworks of understanding the female reproductive system – such as metaphors of upturned jars – as well as relating to fertility symbols from the natural landscape. They concern wishes for a healthy pregnancy and delivery.



Which uteri type are
you?



Kirsty TURNBULL

Evan's object of the term

People in the past must have played jokes on each other. The fact that archaeology puts such a big focus on people's mode of subsistence, sociopolitical organisation and symbolic beliefs, can make the past seem very distant to our entertainment-filled world. I think our understanding of history is in urgent need of a dose of fun, which is why this object stood out to me on a recent visit to the Roman fort of Vindolanda in Northumberland.



It's a little leather mouse, about life size, preserved as part of a large collection of organic material due to favourable anaerobic conditions at the site. In fact, the mouse was just placed in a bag full of scrap leather when it was found and stored in 1993. It wasn't until lockdown in 2020 when the curators had more time to meticulously go through the stores, that the little mouse came to light.

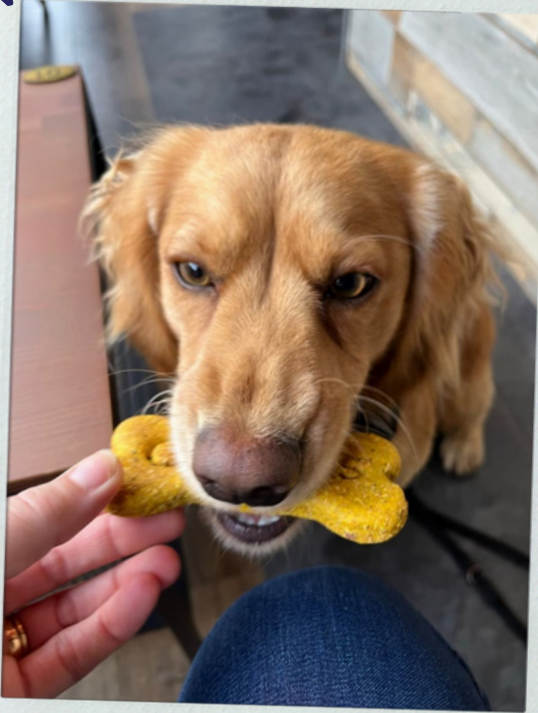
The mouse had come from one of the rooms belonging to a commanding officer, built between 105-130CE. It's perhaps telling that, in the nearby granary buildings, the bones of hundreds of dead mice, having been feasting on the stores of grain, were found. The person who created this leather toy was clearly influenced by what was going on in the immediate vicinity and played on worries that people no doubt had about mice scuttling about.

The mouse may have been a 'toy', that word we use when something doesn't seem to have any practical or clear symbolic value in the adult world. But why couldn't this have been used by adults? In these poorly-lit, dark rooms, it was easy to mistake a small leather mouse for the actual thing and its possible it was used to play a practical joke on others.

Objects like this help us see beyond the Roman military as it is usually stereotyped: a purely serious war machine. Rather, people in the military probably engaged in jokes and play that responded to the environments around them. By excluding adult play from our understanding of archaeology, we miss a lot of the complexities and fun of the past.

DOGS (et al.) ON "DIGS"

Our beloved pets have continued to keep us company outside of the excavation season :-D A few old photos & a few from recent Easter break activities...



post excavation snack
(digging up the garden)

->>
Tutu sleeping
after a tiring
day barking at
the Menorca
Archaeology
Project drone
at Torre d'en
Galmés

Gregoire and
Foxy searching
for FLINT

The cats of
Rome

A Roman brick
with paw print
from the
Austria trip



Charlie with a trowel



Esha on tor



P5 PLUS

6 3 0 6

P5 PLUS

21

20A

20

19A

19

18A

18

17A

LIBATIONS...

LOOKING TO DRINK THE EXAM TERM STRESS AWAY BUT UNWILLING TO ABANDON YOUR UNDYING PASSION FOR ARCHAEOLOGY? YOU'VE COME TO THE RIGHT PLACE



NEBULA SKY DISC(O)

- ONE SHOT VODKA
 - ONE SHOT BLUE CURAÇAO
 - CRANBERRY JUICE
 - EDIBLE GOLD GLITTER
- *EDITOR'S NOTE; THIS ONE MIGHT LOOK GOOD BUT IT TASTES ABSOLUTELY FOUL



MEDIEVAL MEDITERRANEAN

- ONE SHOT GIN
- ONE SHOT BLUE CURAÇAO
- LEMONADE
- LEMON SLICE
- PAPER BOAT OPTIONAL



THE GRAVELS OF FORDWICH

- GERMAN PEPPERMINT LIQUEUR FROM THE SUPERMARKET IN MUNICH
- OATLY CHOCOLATE MILK OR GENERAL CHOCOLATE MILK IF YOU ARE NOT FEEBLE OF STOMACH
- OREOS, SEPARATED WITH THE WHITE PARTS MELTED AND APPLIED TO THE RIM OF THE GLASS TO ADHERE TO OREO CRUMBS



MOSAICS!!!

NEBRA SKY DISC (IF
YOU SQUINT)



TORC!!!



TORC-ING
HEADS ALBUM
COVER



MAMMOTH <3



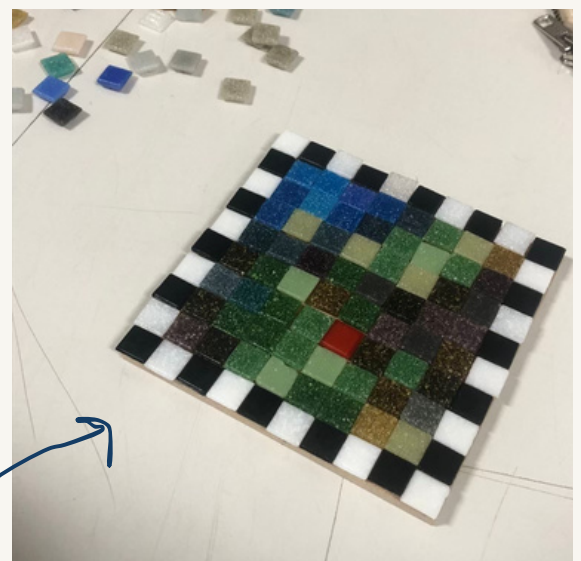
FOX



FLOWERS



MAP....



AFC Feast 2024

AFC Feast



After many long-awaited years, the committee of 2023/24 managed to pull something off that hadn't been seen since the dawn of time.... An AFC Feast! On the 12th of March we invited the archaeologists (and some of their friends) to attend the first official formal since the Covid pandemic halted the society's social events. The resurrection of the society has been slowly building over the last two years with the help of ambitious undergraduates who wanted to reinvigorate the sense of community that has been missing amongst the cohorts.

We laughed, some drank, and enjoyed each other's company at Homerton as we celebrated a year of AFC events. You all got the pleasure of listening to Lord Simon Woolley's impressive speech and farewell for the easter break. With a turnout of 31 people, almost all of whom turned up on time (naming no names), we saw a gathering of undergraduate archaeology students that cross-cut year groups to come together and break bread.

It was no easy task to organise and there are many things that the next committee can work towards next year but on behalf of this committee I would like to thank everyone for attending and ask that you all continue the tradition of the annual AFC Feast!

*Your 2023/24 Events Officer
Katja*

Class of 2024!



Committee of 2023/24!



FROM THE (OUTGOING) COMMITTEE

Evan (Secretary)

Lent term as Secretary has been really fun and I've particularly enjoyed our mosaic making session as well as the end of term feast! As this committee comes to an end, I wanted to say thank you for all work put in to run the fun activities we've had over the past year. I'm looking forward to staying on in the committee and the next year of AFC shenanigans!

Alasdair (Treasurer)

Hello (again), I'm back! Lent has been a muddle of a term with bonkers things throughout. Lectures have been curious, A11 has been strenuous, & thoughts of Bell Beakers have kept me going just about. The fieldtrips have, of course, been a highlight (I love reconstructed early Neolithic longhouses) as have society events - especially my terrible tessellated rendition of the Nebra sky disc. Re-election brings a few benefits, and as AFC Treasurer (now for a second year), I can now fully enter my element. There is quite literally nothing the society can do to stop me. I might convert all society accounts into a nice Iron Age torc, and then ceremonially deposit it under the courtyard tree. I have little hope for Easter Term, may the good Lord have mercy upon us all.

Katja (Social Secretary)

(Katja could not be reached. She may be underground somewhere in the Andes phenomenologising 'sacred depths'. Or communing with Sebastian Vettel.)

Izzy (Publicity & Stash Officer)

Our final term on the committee has been another busy one! I've been trying (and mostly succeeding?) to get t-shirts and tote bags made, as well as seeing the Trumpington cross within a tomato, which would probably mean something significant to the Anglo-Saxons. My other AFC highlights this term have been the Ice Age movie night (although Team Manny sadly lost to Team Diego), the lovely AFC Feast at Homerton (wonderful vegan dessert...) and our mosaics night with the Classics Society. Otherwise, I've been doing a lot of thinking about peat bogs in the Iron Age (liminal places? meeting places? something else entirely?), managing to work a Talking Heads reference into my dissertation title, and fearfully planning life after Cambridge... Good luck to the new committee!!

Hannah (Vice President)

I have spent the past few months in an illiterate haze. Otherwise, the last term has been lovely. One of the highlights has been seeing the undergrad community connecting through the AFC - at socials, online, and over coffees in the break room - and want to thank everyone involved (especially my fellow committee members)! Our society's objective at the start of this year was to revive the sense of community which was somewhat lost over the Covid years and I think that we can safely say the AFC is now entering a new golden era in this respect. All best wishes to the new committee :) + good luck with exams !!

Mia (President)

It has been an honour to be your AFC President these last 12 months. It has been extremely eventful year for the AFC, and it has been great to see the full revival of an Archaeology society at the university. I would like to thank my committee Evan, Alasdair, Katja and Izzy for their amazing work and support, none of this would be possible without them. A special thank you to Hannah for putting together these newsletters and being an amazing Vice President as well as a great friend. I also extend by thanks to Simon Stoddart for being a great Senior Treasurer who has been great help. Also, a huge thank you to Tamsin, Koenraad, Josh, Lydia, the McDonald and the department receptionists for always being around to help us with funding, publicity and organisation!

I look forward to seeing what Evan and the new committee has in store over the next year, I am sure the AFC is in capable hands! Next year I will be leaving archaeology to pursue my passions for teaching doing a PGCE in History at Oxf*rd.